

COVID-19 Maternal Immunization Tracker (COMIT)

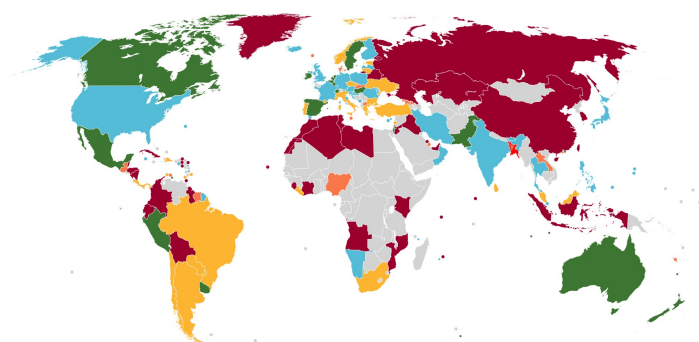
COVID-19 vaccine policies for pregnant and lactating people worldwide

July 2021

Overview

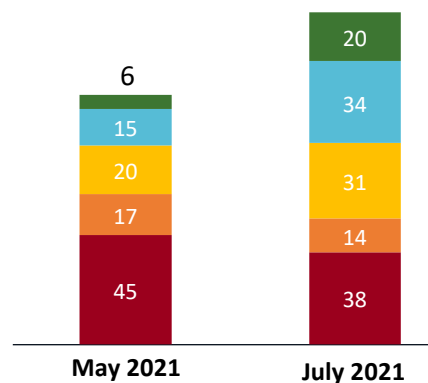
COMIT is a new resource for the global health community that provides a snapshot of national COVID-19 vaccination policies for pregnant and lactating people worldwide. Through maps, tables, and country profiles, COMIT offers up-to-date information on evolving vaccination policies and recommendations from professional medical societies as countries respond to the dynamic pandemic and emerging evidence on vaccines.

More countries are beginning to recommend COVID-19 vaccination for pregnant and lactating people.



July 2021

- Not recommended
- Not recommended but with exceptions
- Permitted with qualifications
- Permitted
- Recommended for some or all



However, policies continue to vary widely among countries.

20 countries

have an explicit recommendation that some or all pregnant people should receive vaccination. Of these, Mexico and Pakistan are the only non-high-income countries to recommend COVID-19 vaccination for pregnant women.

38 countries

have policies noting that people who are pregnant should not receive the vaccine or that the vaccine is contraindicated.

14 countries

have announced policies recommending COVID-19 vaccination for pregnant and lactating people in the last two months (since May 2021)

World Health Organization has issued guidance on COVID-19 vaccines



WHO guidance permits the use in pregnant and lactating women of all COVID-19 vaccines for which it has issued interim recommendations.

These six vaccines include:

- Johnson & Johnson/Janssen
- Moderna
- Oxford-AstraZeneca
- Pfizer/BioNTech
- Sinopharm
- Sinovac

Countries face unique circumstances and consider a variety of factors when determining COVID-19 vaccination policies for pregnant and lactating people.



Israel recommends COVID-19 vaccine for pregnant women

Following the deaths of pregnant women and their fetuses in early 2021, Israel started recommending the Pfizer and BioNTech COVID-19 vaccine for pregnant and breastfeeding women in February 2021. Multiple factors are associated with the country's success in vaccinating pregnant women, including its small size, relatively young population, centralized national government system, strong logistics capacity, and rapid mobilization of special government funding.

Link: [Guidance statement from the Ministry of Health](#)



Brazil suspends use of AstraZeneca vaccine in pregnant women after death

On May 11, Brazil suspended its national COVID-19 vaccination of pregnant and lactating women following the death of a 35-year-old woman who was 23 weeks pregnant and died from a hemorrhagic stroke, possibly related to vaccination. Following investigation, many Brazilian states have resumed vaccinating pregnant and lactating women with comorbidities with Pfizer and Sinovac vaccines.

Link: [Guidance statement from regulator ANVISA](#)



U.K. expanding vaccination of pregnant women

As part of the broader rollout of the COVID-19 vaccine, all pregnant women will have been offered the Pfizer or Moderna vaccine within the next few weeks. Uptake among pregnant women is currently around 40% and the focus now is to increase that figure by providing accurate, up-to-date information to counter misinformation spreading on social media.

Link: [Guidance statement from Public Health England](#)



South Africa permits vaccination of pregnant women with co-morbidities or at high risk of exposure

On April 29, South Africa issued guidance that pregnant women at high risk of exposure to COVID-19 or who have comorbidities which add to their risk of severe COVID-19 disease may be vaccinated in consultation with their health care provider.

Link: [Guidance statement from South African Health Products Regulatory Authority](#)

Excerpts from country vaccination guidance

To achieve the primary objective of the GTAV strategy, to reduce mortality from COVID-19, and its most recent recommendation to reduce maternal mortality, Stage 3 of the National Policy will be to immunize people aged 50 to 59 years and pregnant women aged 18 and over from the third month of pregnancy, vaccinating a total of approximately 15.2 million people.

May 11, 2021
Government of Mexico
[National Policy for Vaccination Against the SARS-CoV-2 Virus](#)

Based on the most recent scientific data and recommendations, the SHC states that all pregnant women should be vaccinated as a priority (phase 1b of the campaign), as opposed to non-pregnant women, because of the increased risk of severe COVID-19 infection and preterm delivery. In addition, the SHC confirms that the currently available COVID-19 mRNA vaccines can be safely given to pregnant women.

May 21, 2021
Belgium's Superior Health Council
[Report 9622 - Vaccination against COVID-19 in pregnant women](#)

Who should receive the vaccine:
All adults (including pregnant and lactating women) over the age of 40 years.

June 15, 2021
Pakistan's Ministry of National Health Services Regulation and Coordination
[Vaccine Interim Guidelines](#)

For more information and real-time policy tracking, please visit COMIT at www.comitglobal.org